

Male hormones

Hormones are chemicals produced in the body that send instructions to cells. Each hormone can only affect specific target cells, which contain the appropriate receptor for that hormone.

SEE ALSO

◀ 46–47 What is puberty?

Changing body 50–51 ▶

Testicles 52–53 ▶

Breaking voices 56–57 ▶

Kickstarting puberty

At the start of puberty, gonadotropin-releasing hormone (GnRH) in the brain signals to the body that it's ready to start developing into an adult. GnRH causes an increase in the level of the primary sex hormones in males and females—testosterone in males, and estrogen in females. As puberty continues, these and other hormones regulate and monitor each stage of development.

